

Black defence

By C.G.S.Narayanan

"The definition of defence is not altogether straightforward. The natural meaning implies a black move which defeats a threat. Any black move may contain an element of defence, and must contain an element of error, which goes with it. The simplest form of defence is for black to put a direct GUARD on the threatened mating square or line. The first problem below chosen by the author of the monumental work

"Chess problem: ask and records" achieves an impressive record of 13 pure direct guards with different mates

Jan Hartong
Diagrammes 1977



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Qc3! (2.Qd4) 1...Pc5 2.aRxd6
1...
dPxe5 2.Qc5; 1...fPxe5 2.gRxd6
1...Nb3 2.Qc4 1...Nc2 2.Bxa2
1...Nxf5 2.Qxc6 1...Bf2 2.Nxf6
1...Rxb4 2.Nc7; 1...Qe4 2.Pxe4
1...Qf4 2.Nxf4 1...Qg4, Qg3 2.N(x)e3
1...Qd3 2.Qd3 1...Qf2 2.Pe4

The record for indirect guards, in which one Black piece unmask the guard of another is seen in the second diagram.

E. Ferron

Comm., The Problemist, 2007



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Na4! (2.Nb6); 1...Rxa3
2.Nxa3; 1...Rb3 2.Pxb3; 1...Rc3
2.Nb2; 1...Rd3 2.Pxd3; 1...Rf3
2.Pxf3; 1...Rxe2 2.Qxe2;
1...Re5 2.Pe4; 1...Rxe6+
2.Bxe6; 1...eR else 2.Pe3; 1...N
any 2.R(x)c5.

Problem for solving

S. Leites, 1st prize
Shakhmaty v SSSR, 1946



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving
in the article "Classic Three-
movers"

Key: 1.Rd6! ~2.d4/Re4,
1...Rxe3 2.d4; 1...Bxe3 2. Re4;
1...Rxf5 2.Ng4; 1...Bxf5 2.Rf7,
1...Rxd2, Nxd6, Nc3/Nf2
2.Re4, Rc5, d4)

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